



# Change Management Policy

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| Document Signoff |                                                                                     |                  |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
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| CEO              |  | 07 November 2021 |

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|                        |            |                                |                      |
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|                        |            |                                |                      |

## 1. Purpose

- 1.1 Change Management refers to a formal process for making changes to IT systems.
- 1.2 Change management aims to increase awareness and understanding of proposed changes across an organization and ensure that all changes are made in a thoughtful way that minimizes negative impact to services and customers.

## 2. Scope

- 2.1 This policy applies to all changes to architectures, tools and IT Services provided by Massar IT department. Modifications made to non-production systems (such as testing environments with no impact on production IT Services) are outside the scope of this policy.

## 3. Responsibilities

- 3.1 IT Manager is responsible for overall implementation, maintaining of this Policy document and is to ensure that the Policy is communicated to all Massar employees and adhered to.
- 3.2 Circulation of this document and subsequent updates are controlled and monitored by the IT Manager in line with the Control of Document (MAS-QH-PR-001).

## 4. Definitions

- 4.1 Change: The addition, modification, or removal of approved, supported, or baselined hardware, network, software, application, environment, system, or associated documentation.
- 4.2 Change Advisory Board: A group of people that support the assessment, prioritization, authorization, and scheduling of changes.
- 4.3 Change Control: The procedure to ensure that all changes are controlled, including the submission, analysis, decision making, approval, implementation, and post implementation of the change.
- 4.4 Change History: Auditable information that records, for example, what was done, when it was done, by whom and why.
- 4.5 Change Log: Auditable log of who, what, why, and when for all changes. This may be system specific as certain systems have the ability to automatically log changes in this manner.
- 4.6 Change Management: Process of controlling changes to the infrastructure or any aspect of services and software, in a controlled manner, enabling approved changes with minimum disruption.
- 4.7 Core Service: A service that users directly consume, and the organization receives value from.
- 4.8 Enabling Service: A service that must be in place for a core service to be delivered.
- 4.9 Enhancing Service: A service that adds extra value to a service but is not absolutely required.
- 4.10 Impact: Determined by potential disruption to users, departments, colleges, customers, and the organization.
- 4.11 Peer: Another IT professional that can review a change and understand the technical elements involved.
- 4.12 Process Log: A central repository of Changes that documents the process followed for a particular change. The purpose of the process log is to ensure that high impact changes have been carefully considered and to serve as a basis for process improvement when changes do not go as planned.
- 4.13 Request for Change (RFC): A formal proposal for a change to be made. It includes details for the proposed change.

- 4.1.4 Urgency: How quickly a change must be implemented to maintain stated service level agreement (SLA). Low and Medium can wait until the next scheduled CAB meeting, High cannot and needs to be done ASAP

## **5. Policy**

- 5.1 Each Change shall follow an appropriate complete change management process commensurate with the type of change being authorized.

### **5.2 Minimum Standard**

- 5.2.1 All Changes must follow a process of planning, evaluation, review, approval, and documentation. See "Clause 9 – Process Examples" for default approaches.
- 5.2.2 Directors serve as default Change Authorities (CA) for changes within their units and have the authority to determine change type and risk level. If in doubt, a higher level of risk should be assumed, and additional review and approval should be sought.
- 5.2.3 All Standard Changes must have documented procedures in place that have been approved by the Director or delegate.
- 5.2.4 All Changes must be approved by the Change Advisory Board (CAB).
- 5.2.5 All Emergency Changes must be authorized by a manager and submitted for review by the CAB in retrospect to ensure that effective oversight was maintained, and proper communication occurred. NOTE: If services are down, the issue should be handled as an Incident according to the Incident Response Policy.
- 5.2.6 Documentation of Normal Medium, Normal High, and Emergency Changes must be made in a Process log that is stored in a common location so that coordination of changes across the organization can be managed appropriately.
- 5.2.7 Low risk Normal and Standard Changes must be logged in a manner that can be audited for process improvement and root cause diagnosis as part of Problem Management.
- 5.2.8 All changes are elevated one Change Type priority level during Critical Operations Windows.

## **6. Types of Changes and Definitions**

There are three types of changes:

### **6.1 Standard Change**

- 6.1.1 A repeatable change that has been pre-authorized by the Change Authority by means of a documented procedure that controls risk and has predictable outcomes.

### **6.2 Normal Change**

- 6.2.1 A change that is not an emergency change or a Standard change. Normal changes follow the defined steps of the change management process. Low, Medium, or High priority is determined by Directors or delegates according to the Risk Assessment Instrument included in Clause 7.
- 6.2.1.1 Normal Low Changes must be reviewed and approved by the Director or delegate as Change Authority.
- 6.2.1.2 Normal Medium & High Changes must be reviewed and approved by the Director and Change Advisory Board as Change Authority.

### **6.3 Emergency Change**

- 6.3.1 A change that must be introduced as soon as possible due to likely negative service impacts. There may be fewer people involved in the change management process review, and the change assessment may involve fewer steps due to the urgent nature of the issue; however, any Emergency Change must still be authorized by a manager and reviewed by the Change Advisory Board retroactively.

## 7. Risk Assessment

### 7.1 Risk and Change Type Matrix for Normal and Emergency Changes

7.1.1 Determine the impact of the change to the service. Then assess the Urgency of the proposed change (Low and Medium changes can wait until the next scheduled CAB meeting, High cannot and needs to be done ASAP). The matrix shows whether the type of change is then a Normal Low, Normal Medium, Normal High, or an emergency change.

|                                                                           | Low Urgency | Medium Urgency | High Urgency |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|----------------|--------------|
| <b>Impact - Organization</b><br>Change affects more than 100 individuals. | Medium      | High           | Emergency    |
| <b>Impact - Department</b><br>Change affects more than 5 individuals.     | Medium      | High           | High         |
| <b>Impact - User</b><br>Change affects less than 5 or less individuals.   | Low         | Low            | Medium       |

## 8. Change Management Roles

### 8.1 Change Advisory Board (CAB)

The members of the Change Advisory Board provide a due diligence readiness assessment and advice about timing for any Request for Change (RFC) that are referred to it for review. This assessment should ensure that all changes to the IT environment are carefully considered to minimize the impact on campus users and existing services.

### 8.2 CAB members are responsible for:

- 8.2.1 Thoroughly reviewing all change requests.
- 8.2.2 Raising any potential concerns about the impact or timing of those requests.
- 8.2.3 Ensuring the changes requested
  - 8.2.3.1 Have undergone proper planning and testing
  - 8.2.3.2 Changes are planned to ensure the lowest possible risk to services
  - 8.2.3.3 Changes are coordinated so changes do not impact each other
- 8.2.4 Providing advice regarding any additional measures that should be considered prior to the change

### 8.3 Project Office

- 8.3.1 Change Management responsibilities for first level managers include the following tasks:
  - 8.3.1.1 Ensure that Requestor fills out the RFC accurately and completely
  - 8.3.1.2 Prepare the request for change (RFC) and submit to CAB.
  - 8.3.1.3 Ensure staff availability to successfully complete the RFC
  - 8.3.1.4 Ensure that the RFC is documented throughout the life cycle from when an RFC is created until the change is implemented in production.

## 9. Process Examples

### 9.1 Plan

- 9.1.1 Collect information to make the change; perform testing; review documentation

### 9.2 Evaluate

- 9.2.1 Determine the risk, priority.

### **9.3 Review**

- 9.3.1 Conduct internal review on the requirement, risk, and priority in weekly stream leads meeting.
- 9.3.2 Prepare the request for change (RFC) by project office.

### **9.4 CAB**

- 9.4.1 Review & approval for RFC.

### **9.5 Development**

- 9.5.1 Change is in the development phase.

### **9.6 User Acceptance Testing:**

- 9.6.1 Scheduling: To be governed by Project management office.
- 9.6.2 Testing: To be conducted by the business user/users concerned.
- 9.6.3 Documentation: Testing results must be formally documented and signed off by the business user/users concerned.

### **9.7 Communicate**

- 9.7.1 Priority 1: Send notification to Outages.
- 9.7.2 Priority 2: Send targeted e-mail to affected customers only as needed.

### **9.8 Implement**

- 9.8.1 Make the change

## **10. Change Plan Documentation**

Changes, evaluations, and approvals will be documented (IT Business Case for Change- MAS-FM-IT-024 )to allow customers to understand what was changed, the reason it was done and the process that was used to make a change. The following details the kind of information that will be logged for each change and where it will be logged.

### **10.1 Change Log**

The Change Log contains

- 10.1.1 Who made the change
- 10.1.2 What was changed
- 10.1.3 Why the change was made (Reason/Comment)
- 10.1.4 When the change was made

### **10.2 Process Log**

The Process Log contains o Test Plan and testing results

- 10.2.1 Risk assessment documentation
- 10.2.2 Communication Plan
- 10.2.3 Implementation Plan, including back-out contingencies